

Dark Chocolate & Pistachio Molasses Cookies

Chewy center · crisp edge · salt-sweet finish

YIELD	ACTIVE	CHILL	BAKE	DOUGH WT
~16 @ 120g	25 min	24–36 hr	14–16 min @ 350°F	~1,960 g

TARGETS

judge by these — the butter step is everything

Butter + sugar	Cold cubed butter, paddle, speed 2, 45–60 sec. Chunky and uneven — NOT creamed to light/fluffy.
Dough ball	120g (±5g), pressed rough — craggy surface cracks better.
Pull temp	175°F internal — carryover finishes it to 180–185°F.
Visual pull	Edges set and cracking, center jiggles when the pan is shaken.
Spacing	8–10 cm (3–4") between balls, 4 per half-sheet, center rack.

INGREDIENTS

grouped by how they're used

DRY — WHISK, STEP 2

Bread flour 14% protein	438 g
Pistachios toasted, ground fine	140 g
Baking powder	4 g
Baking soda	3 g
Salt fine/kosher, by weight	6 g

BUTTER + SUGAR — STEP 3

Salted butter cold, 1cm cubes	336 g
Light brown sugar packed	360 g
Molasses unsulphured	80 g

WET — STEP 4

Whole eggs room temp	2
Egg yolks room temp	2
Vanilla extract	28 g

FOLD-IN — STEP 6

Dark chocolate 60%, ~1cm chunks	340 g
Pistachios toasted, rough chopped	140 g

FINISH

Flaky sea salt	to finish
Extra chocolate + pistachio for tops	—

Build & Bake

METHOD

no creaming — the cold-butter smash is the whole game

- 1 **Toast:** all 280g pistachios on a sheet, **325°F, 8–10 min**, shake halfway, pull fragrant (not dark). Cool completely, then grind 140g in a food processor (pulse 8–10×, coarse sand); rough-chop the other 140g.
- 2 **Dry:** whisk flour, ground pistachios, baking powder, baking soda, salt. Set aside.
- 3 **Butter + sugar:** paddle, cold cubed butter + brown sugar + molasses. **Speed 2 only, 45–60 sec.** It stays chunky and uneven — that's correct. **Do NOT cream** to light/fluffy. Scrape the bowl.
- 4 **Eggs:** speed 2. Add whole eggs, yolks, vanilla. Mix **~30 sec**, just combined — no egg streaks. Scrape.
- 5 **Combine:** speed 2 (stir). Dry mix in two additions: first half ~10 sec, second half **stop when a few flour streaks remain**. Don't walk away — overmix = tough.
- 6 **Fold:** off the mixer. Add chocolate + chopped pistachios. Stiff spatula — cut the center, scrape the bottom, fold **~10–15 times** until evenly distributed.
- 7 **Portion:** zero a plate on the scale, scoop to **120g**. Press into a rough ball with both hands — don't compress it smooth. Craggy surface cracks better. 4 per parchment tray.
- 8 **Ferment:** wrap the tray tightly, fridge **24–36 hr** (24 min, 36 ideal). The dough darkens as sugar breaks down — that's the toffee/caramel development.
- 9 **Bake:** temper **10–15 min** at room temp. **350°F**, parchment, light-colored sheet, 8–10cm spacing, center rack. Rotate at 8 min. Total **14–16 min**: edges golden & cracked, center jiggles when shaken. **Pull at 175°F internal** — carryover finishes it.
- 10 **Finish:** flaky salt immediately. Press extra chocolate/pistachio into the surface while tacky. Cool on the pan **15 min** (still baking on residual heat), then to a wire rack.

The cold-butter smash — the most important step: do NOT cream. Cold cubed butter smashed with sugar on low speed keeps air *out*. Air = cakey; no air = dense, fudgy, chewy. Creaming to light-and-fluffy (or mixing above speed 2) is the #1 way this cookie goes wrong.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Flat / spread	Under-fermented or butter too warm → re-chill; butter must be cold cubed
Cakey	Creamed too long / above speed 2 → cold cubed butter, speed 2, 45–60 sec max
Airy / crumbly	Too much baking soda → verify 3g , not more
Tough	Overmixed at combine → pull at 14 min; check internal temp
Raw center	Balls too cold → temper 10–15 min, or add 2 min bake
Edges brown, center raw	Oven too hot for ball size → drop to 325°F, extend 2–3 min
Too sticky to portion	Dough too warm → fridge 15 min, then portion
Bland	Under-salted → verify 6g salt + the flaky finish

NOTES

the non-obvious bits

Chocolate: eating-quality bar, hand-chopped ~1cm — not chips (stabilizers block melt pools).

Pistachios: cool completely before grinding or they oil out to paste.

Make ahead: freeze portioned balls solid, bag; bake from frozen +2–3 min (keeps 3 months).

Storage: airtight, room temp, 4–5 days — never refrigerate (staling).